

Chatting Heavily with ChatGPT: Investigating Usefulness, Privacy, Integrity, Ease, and Intention as Drivers of Technology Acceptance Among Business Communication Students

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Abstract

Teachers, students, and professionals widely use ChatGPT for business communication. Recent studies have explored predictors driving its adoption, predominantly from a general education perspective. To address this gap, this study examines predictors and barriers encountered by English for Specific Purposes (ESP) learners in India, a developing market with a significant number of ChatGPT users enrolled in business communication (BC) courses. A model based on the Unified Theory of Acceptance and Use of Technology (UTAUT2) was proposed, incorporating seven predictors to assess their influence on the intention to use ChatGPT. Structural equation modeling (SEM) was performed on 526 students' responses from two reputed Indian private universities, yielding a good model fit (minimum discrepancy by degree of freedom = 2.95, goodness of fit index [GFI] = 0.945, root mean square error of approximation [RMSEA] = 0.043). Further, the results identified five significant predictors: perceived usefulness ($\beta = 0.234$, $p < 0.001$), academic integrity ($\beta = 0.291$, $p = 0.003$), perceived ease of participation ($\beta = 0.174$, $p = 0.013$), privacy concerns ($\beta = 0.224$, $p = 0.004$), and perceived ease of participation's effect on perceived usefulness ($\beta = 0.354$, $p < 0.001$). However, peer behavior ($\beta = -0.032$, $p = 0.769$) and security concerns ($\beta = -0.059$, $p = 0.434$) were found to be insignificant predictors. The findings suggest

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that ChatGPT adoption is shaped by perceived functionality, ethical confidence, ease of use, and privacy assurance, while peer behavior and security concerns play a limited role, likely due to the tool's early-stage adoption and individualistic usage patterns. This study highlights the importance of addressing barriers through targeted training, transparent policies, and AI literacy initiatives to ensure responsible and effective integration of ChatGPT in academic and professional contexts.

Keywords

ChatGPT adoption, business communication, English writing and learning, privacy concerns, security concerns, academic integrity

Introduction

The rapid evolution of artificial intelligence (AI) tools has captured the attention of business professionals, teachers, and students worldwide, offering vast opportunities for innovation in professional training, teaching, and learning (Fu & Weng, 2024; Kohnke et al., 2023; Ma, 2024; Sullivan et al., 2023). Among these tools, ChatGPT has emerged as a focal point, particularly for language teachers and business communication students, because of its remarkable ability to respond to learners' queries promptly and in multiple languages (Fryer et al., 2025; Lee & Chung, 2024; Kohnke & Moorhouse, 2024). In this regard, researchers and educators have long anticipated that AI's accelerating development would transform educational methodologies, creating new paradigms in teaching and learning (Getchell et al., 2022). Specifically, ChatGPT, in particular, stands out as a "game changer" in AI-assisted writing and education (Mollick, 2022; van Dis et al., 2023, p. 224), indicating a shift that scholars and educators must acknowledge that writing practices and pedagogical approaches will never be the same again (Cardon et al., 2023). Notably, prominent technology leaders have also emphasized the transformative potential of generative AI tools. In this regard, Bill Gates described ChatGPT as "every bit as important as the PC, as the internet" (Nerozzi, 2023), while Satya Nadella (CEO of Microsoft) highlighted its capacity to revolutionize productivity and scalability across various industries worldwide (Schechner, 2023). These acknowledgments highlight ChatGPT's significant capabilities, particularly its use of large language models (LLMs), which enable it to handle a wide range of user queries. However, despite its potential, ChatGPT has raised concerns about its implications for education and workplace tasks, such as AI-assisted writing in business communication (Getchell et al., 2022; Strzelecki, 2023). These concerns emphasize the importance of understanding ChatGPT's adoption on a global scale.

The Indian higher education system, known for its large and diverse student population, provides a unique context to explore ChatGPT adoption. India's private universities, in particular, are hubs of innovation, with significant investments in AI technologies to enhance educational quality (Wadia & Shamsu, 2021). By focusing on

English for Specific Purposes (ESP) learners in Indian private universities, this study examines ChatGPT's relevance in a developing market where digital tools are increasingly adopted for professional training and academic purposes. Understanding the predictors and barriers specific to this context offers valuable insights into how ChatGPT can be integrated into similar global educational settings.

This study investigates two key questions: What factors influence students' intentions to adopt ChatGPT for business communication? How do privacy, security, and academic integrity concerns shape these intentions? By examining students' intentions to use ChatGPT, the study offers valuable insights into how this transformative tool influences learning behaviors and academic outcomes. While ChatGPT enhances teaching-learning activities under proper supervision, it also introduces challenges such as generating hallucinated citations (Cooper, 2023), designing lesson plans (Sullivan et al., 2023), and supporting essay writing (van Dis et al., 2023). These issues necessitate systematic research investigations to prevent misleading or plagiarized information and ensure the ethical and effective integration of ChatGPT into educational practices. Some universities cautiously evaluate ChatGPT's role in education (Waghmare, 2023), while others encourage students to explore its limitations, promoting critical thinking and informed integration into learning processes (Lim et al., 2023).

Despite its promise, significant gaps remain in understanding ChatGPT's application across academic contexts. Most existing studies focus on its role in general education and medical sciences (Cotton et al., 2023; Gilson et al., 2023), with limited attention to its application in language learning (Kohnke et al., 2023) and business communication (Ayinde et al., 2023; Chui et al., 2022; Sharma & Pandey, 2024). Addressing these gaps is crucial to managing the ethical and pedagogical challenges associated with AI integration, including concerns about data privacy, security, and academic integrity. This study provides valuable insights to guide the integration of ChatGPT into higher education, promoting ethical practices and reducing perceived risks among students and teachers.

To examine ChatGPT's adoption, this study employs the Unified Theory of Acceptance and Use of Technology (UTAUT2) model. A questionnaire adapted from Kim (2020) measures students' intentions and concerns, focusing on perceived usefulness, academic integrity, ease of participation, privacy concerns, security concerns, and peer behavior. The UTAUT2 model has been widely used to test the acceptance of emerging technologies in teaching and learning activities, such as animation (Dajani & Abu Hegleh, 2019), lecture capture systems (Farooq et al., 2017), online learning platforms (Zacharis & Nikolopoulou, 2022; Qamar et al., 2024), and mobile learning (Hoi, 2020; Qamar et al., 2023). By employing this framework, the study offers a robust approach to understanding students' perceptions of ChatGPT.

Generative AI tools, including ChatGPT, have also introduced broader ethical and pedagogical dilemmas that demand timely attention. Over-reliance on ChatGPT can advance dependency among students, raising concerns about its reliability for academic tasks (Z. Li, 2023). Additionally, scepticism about the credibility of AI-training datasets and concerns regarding data security complicate its widespread

adoption (Goldstein et al., 2023; Wu et al., 2024). Therefore, addressing these challenges is essential to ensuring the responsible integration of generative AI tools into higher education. As a result, this study aims to provide practical insights to support educators, policymakers, and institutions in handling these challenges and effectively utilizing ChatGPT to enhance teaching and learning practices.

Theoretical Framework and Hypothesis Development

Technology Adoption and Intention to Use

In this study, perceived usefulness assesses how beneficial students find ChatGPT for enhancing their business communication skills. The degree to which students consider ChatGPT to be easy and straightforward to use is measured by their perception of its ease of use. Peer behavior examines how the actions and attitudes of students influence individual intentions to adopt ChatGPT. Privacy concerns address the students' apprehensions regarding the security of their personal information while using ChatGPT. Academic integrity considers the students' perception of ChatGPT's adherence to ethical standards in academic settings. Intention to use ChatGPT measures the overall willingness of students to incorporate the tool to fulfill their academic needs.

Based on the intention, users tend to behave in specific ways, making it a significant predictor of behavior (Aaker, 1991, as cited in Kim, 2021); beliefs and attitudes guide prior behavior toward committing specific actions (Davis et al., 1989; Fishbein & Ajzen, 1975; Oliver, 1980). This study focuses on students' intent to use ChatGPT as the dependent variable to examine factors preventing or promoting its adoption. "Intention to use ChatGPT" refers to the student's readiness and willingness to commit to using ChatGPT. In this regard, previous studies have explored behavioral intention and its motivators (Grau-Valldosera et al., 2019; Guo et al., 2016; Kim, 2019; Kim & Kim, 2017; Yang et al., 2017; Zhou, 2017; Zhu et al., 2020). Within this context, theories such as the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB; Fishbein & Ajzen, 1975) and the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM; Davis, 1986) provide the foundation for examining predictors that motivate students to use ChatGPT (Figure 1).

Key Constructs and Hypotheses Development

Perceived usefulness. Technology and its perceived usefulness are "the extent to which people believe that the ability to perform a given task is improved by using a particular technology or system" (Kim et al., 2018). Describing the intention to use a particular technology becomes significant if users believe it will enhance their skills (F. Abdullah & Ward, 2016; F. Abdullah et al., 2016; Kim, 2021). Previous research suggests that perceived usefulness is a key predictor of technology adoption (Davis et al., 1989). For instance, Strzelecki (2023) and Cardon (2023) demonstrated that perceived usefulness positively impacts the intention to use ChatGPT. These findings indicate that learners with greater trust in ChatGPT's capabilities are more inclined to use it.

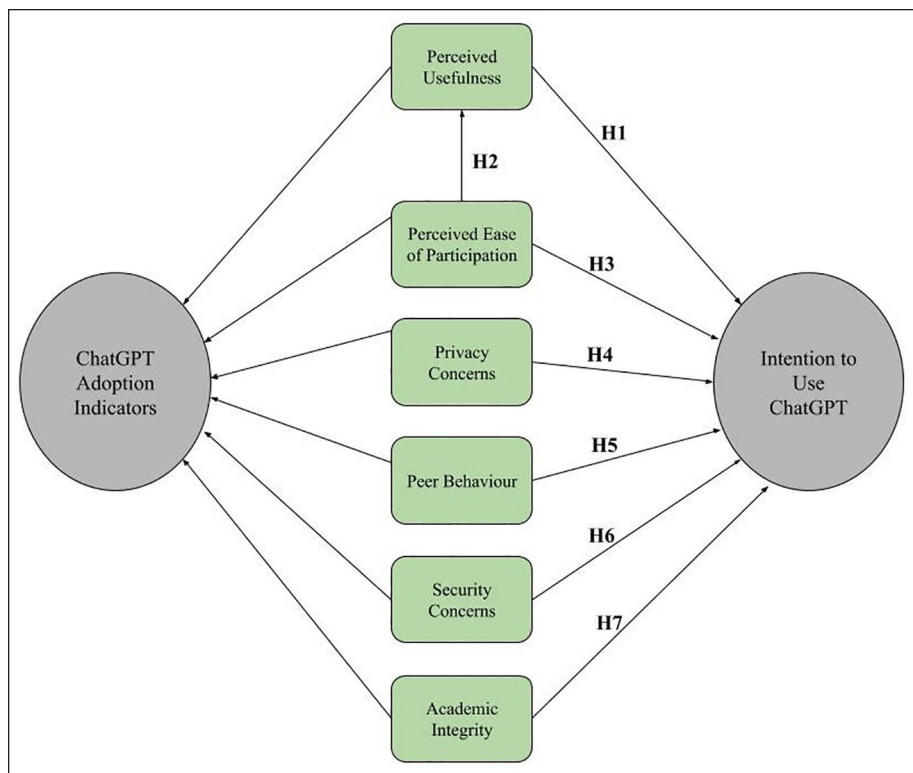


Figure 1. Study's Conceptual Model.

Source: Image by Author.

Research by Al-Emran et al. (2024) further supports the pivotal role of perceived usefulness in enhancing students' learning experiences with AI tools. This study proposes the following hypothesis:

Hypothesis 1: Perceived usefulness positively influences the intention to use ChatGPT.

Perceived ease of participation. In the UTAUT2 framework, perceived ease of use relies on users' perceptions of how simple it is to use a technological system with minimal effort (Davis, 1986; Venkatesh & Davis, 2003). This concept extends to perceived ease of participation, which reflects how effortlessly users can engage with ChatGPT (Cooper, 2023). Previous studies (Alotumi, 2022; Raza et al., 2022) confirm that perceived ease of participation positively affects perceived usefulness (Crawford et al., 2023). Ease of participation not only affects usefulness but also directly influences behavioral intention, as learners find tools requiring minimal effort more appealing (Strzelecki, 2023). This study proposes the following hypotheses:

Hypothesis 2: Perceived ease of participation positively influences perceived usefulness.

Hypothesis 3: Perceived ease of participation positively influences the intention to use ChatGPT.

Privacy concerns. Privacy concerns significantly shape behavior and decision making (Benabou & Tirole, 2003; Wasko & Faraj, 2000). Studies indicate that privacy concerns influence learners' behaviors when adopting technologies (Ko & Kim, 2018; Venkatesh et al., 2003). Applied to ChatGPT, learners may be more willing to adopt the platform if they perceive it as secure and protective of their personal information. Research by Tseng et al. (2022) and Huang et al. (2023) emphasizes the importance of transparent data protection policies in promoting trust among users. This study proposes the following hypothesis:

Hypothesis 4: Privacy concerns positively influence the intention to use ChatGPT.

Peer behavior. Peer behavior influences individuals through social norms and confirmation bias (Nickerson, 1998; Wason, 1960). Negative peer perceptions of ChatGPT could discourage learners from using the platform. Conversely, supportive peer behavior might encourage adoption. The study by Venkatesh et al. (2003) highlights the social dimensions of technology acceptance, with peer influence playing a critical role in early adoption phases. This study proposes the following hypothesis:

Hypothesis 5: Peer behavior negatively influences the intention to use ChatGPT.

Security concerns. Perceived risk, particularly regarding privacy and data security, significantly affects behavioral intention (Liebermann & Paroush, 1982). This concept applies to ChatGPT, where learners' concerns about data breaches may decrease their intention to use the tool (Huang et al., 2023; Strzelecki, 2023). Addressing these concerns with robust technological safeguards can mitigate perceived risks and enhance adoption rates (Kim et al., 2008). This study proposes the following hypothesis:

Hypothesis 6: Security concerns positively influence the intention to use ChatGPT.

Academic integrity. Academic integrity ensures fairness, honesty, and trust in educational practices (Holden et al., 2021). While AI tools offer educational benefits, they also pose ethical concerns, including plagiarism and academic dishonesty (Cotton et al., 2023). ChatGPT's role in maintaining academic integrity requires critical examination. In this regard, ElSayary (2024) notes the dual-edged nature of AI tools, highlighting their potential to enhance learning while also presenting risks to ethical standards. This study proposes the following hypothesis:

Hypothesis 7: Academic integrity positively influences the intention to use ChatGPT.

Methodology

Sampling and Participants

This study employed purposive sampling to target undergraduate and graduate students enrolled in business communication courses at two reputed private universities in India. These universities were selected for their emphasis on technology-integrated curricula and their students' active engagement with innovative digital tools and AI-driven technologies. Purposive sampling was deemed appropriate to ensure that the sample included participants with prior experience using ChatGPT, aligning with the study's objectives. However, this sampling approach may limit the generalizability of the findings beyond the targeted group, potentially excluding broader demographics. The reliance on private university students further narrows the scope, omitting perspectives from public universities or nonbusiness fields. Future studies could adopt inclusive methods like stratified random sampling to improve representativeness.

Further, to meet the inclusion criteria, the first page of the online questionnaire included a Yes/No filter to determine whether participants had used ChatGPT. Students who selected "Yes" were directed to complete the survey, while those who selected "No" were redirected to a submission page. Out of 757 invited participants, 526 completed the survey, yielding a response rate of 69.48%. The sample included frequent users (41.3%), moderate users (18.4%), and rare users (40.3%) of ChatGPT. The majority of respondents were aged 18-23 years (79.4%), followed by those aged 30-35 years (4.6%), 36 years and older (4.0%), and 24-29 years (1.5%). Gender distribution indicated that 63.1% were male, 35.2% were female, and 1.7% preferred not to disclose. While purposive sampling allowed for a focused investigation, its limitation lies in the reduced ability to generalize findings to the broader population.

Measurement Instruments

The study's variables were adopted from well-established scales to ensure validity and reliability (Kim, 2021; Strzelecki, 2023; Venkatesh et al., 2003, 2012). A total of 26 items were used to measure seven variables influencing students' intention to use ChatGPT. Perceived usefulness and perceived ease of participation were each assessed using three items adapted from Davis et al. (1989). Privacy concerns were measured with four items, drawing on prior research by Akhter et al. (2009), Bansal et al. (2008), and Raitman et al. (2005). Peer behavior was evaluated using three items adapted from Dickinger and Kleijnen (2008) and Ko and Kim (2018). Similarly, four items were used to assess security concerns, based on Mittal (1994) and Dickinger and Kleijnen (2008). Academic integrity, a critical variable in the study, was measured using five items adapted from Weinberger et al. (2023). Lastly, intention to use ChatGPT was assessed with four items adapted from Strzelecki (2023). These scales ensured a comprehensive and reliable evaluation of the constructs central to the study.

Questionnaire Development and Validation

The questionnaire was developed based on validated scales and underwent multiple stages of refinement to ensure its reliability and alignment with the study's objectives. Content validity was established through evaluations by two groups: six instructors with expertise in AI integration and six students with ChatGPT experience. These groups reviewed the questionnaire for relevance and clarity, leading to refinements in phrasing to enhance precision. A pilot survey with 30 students was conducted to assess item comprehensibility and reliability, resulting in minor adjustments to improve clarity without altering the meaning of the items. Although the questionnaire was administered exclusively in English, it was thoroughly reviewed to ensure linguistic consistency and accessibility for all respondents. These validation processes strengthened the robustness and appropriateness of the questionnaire for data collection.

Data Collection Procedure

The survey was distributed online using Google Forms, with participants invited via email as well as social media platforms such as LinkedIn and Facebook. A cover letter accompanying the survey explained the study's purpose and assured respondents of confidentiality. The questionnaire comprised demographic questions and Likert-scale items (1=strongly disagree to 5=strongly agree) to measure the main constructs. These measures ensured a structured and comprehensive data collection process.

Data Cleaning and Final Sample

Responses were reviewed for completeness after the initial data collection. Thirty-one responses were excluded because of missing data, resulting in a final sample of 526 participants. This robust sample size ensured the reliability of the findings and provided a solid foundation for subsequent statistical analysis.

Analysis Approach

Exploratory factor analysis (EFA) was performed using varimax rotation to confirm the constructs' validity and reliability. Items with loading values below 0.5 or cross-loadings were removed during the EFA process. Confirmatory factor analysis (CFA) was then conducted to validate the measurement model. The final model demonstrated excellent fit indices (minimum discrepancy/degrees of freedom [CMIN/DF]=2.95, goodness of fit index [GFI]=0.945, comparative fit index [CFI]=0.974, root mean square error of approximation [RMSEA]=0.043), confirming the robustness and reliability of the constructs.

Table 1. Reliability Analysis of ChatGPT Adoption Factors and Constructs.

First-Order Independent Variable (Students' ChatGPT Adoption Factors)	Second-order independent variable	Items	Cronbach's Alpha Value
	Perceived Usefulness	3	0.75
	Perceived Ease of Participation	3	0.72
	Privacy Concern	4	0.81
	Peer Behavior	3	0.73
	Security Concern	4	0.76
	Academic Integrity	5	0.82
	Dependent variable	Items	Cronbach's Alpha Value
	Intention to use ChatGPT	4	0.76

Source: Primary Data.

Results and Findings

Reliability

The reliability analysis was performed using SPSS 22, with Cronbach's alpha employed to evaluate the internal consistency of all variables. The results indicated that all values met the acceptable threshold, demonstrating robust reliability across the constructs. Specifically, perceived usefulness exhibited a reliability of 75% ($\alpha=0.75$), while perceived ease of participation showed a reliability of 72% ($\alpha=0.72$). Privacy concerns demonstrated an 81% consistency ($\alpha=0.81$), and peer behavior reflected a reliability of 73% ($\alpha=0.73$). Similarly, security concerns were measured at 76% reliability ($\alpha=0.76$), and academic integrity exhibited an 82% consistency ($\alpha=0.82$). Additionally, the dependent variable, intention to use ChatGPT, showed a reliability of 76% across four items ($\alpha=0.76$). These findings indicate strong internal consistency among both dependent and independent variables, underscoring the robustness of the measurement model. The high-reliability values across constructs provide confidence in the accuracy and consistency of the data, ensuring the reliability of the subsequent analysis (see Table 1).

Measurement Model

Goodness of fit and standardized estimates. Confirmatory factor analysis (CFA) was conducted to assess the reliability and validity of both constructs and individual items. The goodness of fit of the model was evaluated following the guidelines of Lenka et al. (2009). Initially, the model underwent a parsimonious run across five iterations. The findings indicated a poorly fitted model in the initial run, with the following indices: CMIN/DF=11.69, $\chi^2=2268.4$, DF=194, GFI=0.731, normed fit index

(NFI)=0.489, CFI=0.507, RMSEA=0.142, and p -value=0.000. To address these issues, four modification indices were applied. The refined model demonstrated a significantly improved fit, as evidenced by the updated indices: CMIN/DF=2.71, $\chi^2=413.9$, DF=190, GFI=0.933, NFI=0.900, CFI=0.943, RMSEA=0.047, and p -value=0.000. These results confirmed the adequacy of the modified model's fit. Additionally, the standardized estimates for all items were found to be significant, with factor loadings ranging from 0.431 to 0.865, further supporting the robustness of the constructs.

Convergent and discriminant validity. Using the framework provided by Hair et al. (2015, p. 605), convergent validity was assessed as part of the measurement model evaluation. Convergent validity was determined by examining two key metrics: construct reliability (CR) and average variance extracted (AVE) (Malik et al., 2018). The results demonstrated that the AVE for perceived usefulness was 0.52, with a CR of 0.76. Perceived ease of participation exhibited an AVE of 0.49 and a CR of 0.74. Privacy concerns showed an AVE of 0.60 and a CR of 0.82. For both peer behavior and security concerns, the AVE was 0.45, and the CR was 0.75. Lastly, academic integrity reported an AVE of 0.47 and a CR of 0.81. These values confirm that the constructs met the acceptable thresholds for convergent validity. To assess discriminant validity, the approach recommended by Fornell and Larcker (1981) was applied. According to this method, discriminant validity is established when the AVE of each construct exceeds the corresponding squared inter-construct correlation (SQICOR). In this study, SQICOR values were calculated using Pearson correlation coefficients in SPSS 22, with the correlation values squared to derive the SQICOR. The analysis confirmed that the AVE for all constructs was greater than the respective SQICOR values, verifying the presence of discriminant validity within the measurement model (see Table 2; Figure 2).

Structural Equation Modeling

The structural fit of the model was assessed using the methodologies recommended by Lenka et al. (2009). The analysis revealed satisfactory structural fit, confirming that the model appropriately represented the observed data. Assessing structural goodness of fit was essential to validate the robustness and reliability of the model for subsequent analysis. All fit indices were within the required threshold limits, affirming the suitability of the model for examining causal relationships. After confirming the model's fit, this study investigated the causal connections between the independent variables—perceived usefulness, perceived ease of participation, privacy concerns, peer behavior, security concerns, and academic integrity—and the dependent variable, intention to use ChatGPT. Among the predictors, perceived ease of participation emerged as the most significant, explaining 35.4% of the variance in students' intentions to use ChatGPT ($\beta=0.354$, $p < 0.001$). This result underscores the critical role of user-friendliness in influencing adoption intentions, indicating that students are more likely to adopt ChatGPT when they perceive it as easy to use. Privacy concerns also

Table 2. Goodness of Fit, Convergent Validity, and Discriminant Validity Analysis of ChatGPT Adoption Constructs.

Goodness of Fit and Standardized Estimates					Convergent Validity		Discriminant Validity			
Goodness of Fit Indicators	Parsimonious Block	Improved Block	Observed Variables	Latent Variables	Standardized Estimate	p-value	Convergent Validity		Comparison of AVE and SQICOR	
							Constructs	AVE		CR
CMIN/DF χ² DF	11.69 2268.4 194	2.71 413.9 190	PERUSE1 PERUSE_2 PERUSE_3	← ← ←	F1 F1 F1	0.792 0.663 0.699	Perceived Usefulness	0.52	0.76	AVE > SQICOR Decision: Discriminant validity exists
	GFI NFI CFI	0.731 0.900 0.489	PEREOP_1 PEREOP_2 PEREOP_3	← ← ←	F2 F2 F2	0.596 0.650 0.831	Perceived Ease of Participation	0.49	0.74	AVE > SQICOR Decision: Discriminant validity exists
		0.507 0.142 0.000	PBEH_1 PBEH_2 PBEH_3	← ← ←	F3 F3 F3	0.715 0.733 0.871	Privacy Concern	0.60	0.82	AVE > SQICOR Decision: Discriminant validity exists
RMSEA p-value		0.000	PRCRN_1 PRCRN_2 PRCRN_3	← ← ←	F4 F4 F4	0.467 0.865 0.757	Peer Behavior	0.45	0.75	AVE > SQICOR Decision: Discriminant validity exists
	PRCRN_4 SECCRN_1 SECCRN_2		← ← ←	F4 F5 F5	0.484 0.571 0.791	Security Concern	0.45	0.75	AVE > SQICOR Decision: Discriminant validity exists	
	SECCRN_3 SECCRN_4 ACADIN_1		← ← ←	F5 F5 F6	0.431 0.810 0.694					
ACADIN_2 ACADIN_3 ACADIN_4	← ← ←	F6 F6 F6	0.753 0.737 0.704	Academic Integrity	0.47					0.81
		ACADIN_5	←	F6	0.504	***				

Note. In the model fit measure, a 5-iteration process was followed to achieve the good fit model.
***p < 0.001, indicating a statistically significant factor loading.
AVE = average variance extracted; CFI = comparative fit index; CMIN/DF = minimum discrepancy/degrees of freedom; CR = construct reliability; GFI = goodness of fit index; NFI = normed fit index; RMSEA = root mean square error of approximation; SQICOR = squared inter-construct correlation (calculated by using Pearson correlation and then squaring the correlation value to arrive at squared inter-construct correlation).
Source: Primary Data.

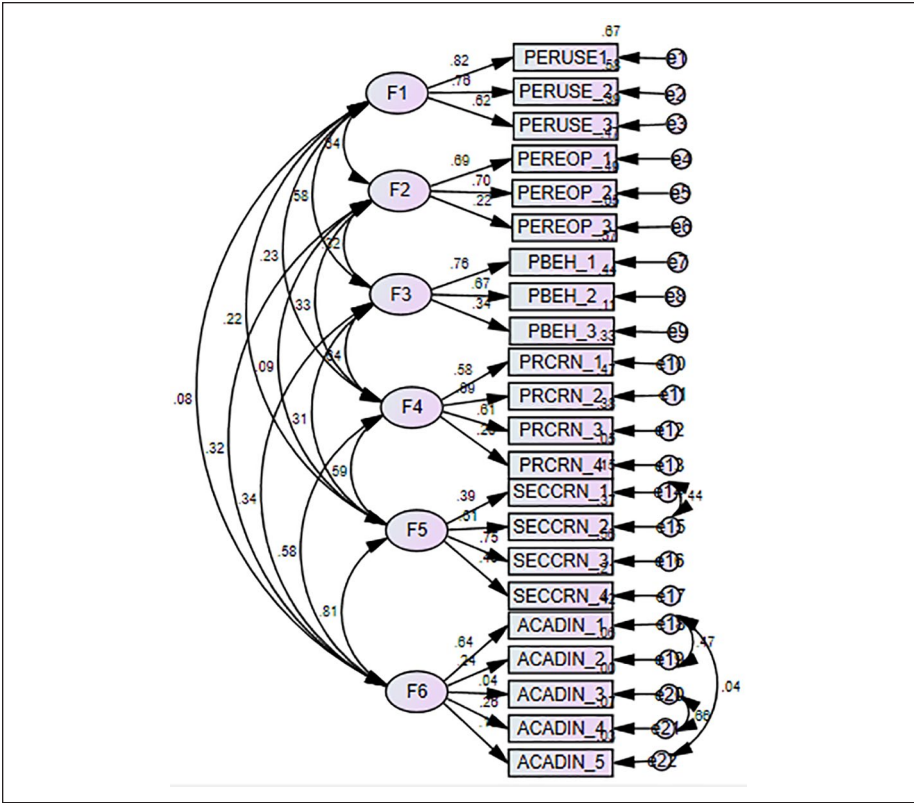


Figure 2. Measurement Model for ChatGPT Adoption Factors.
Source: Primary data.

showed a significant positive impact on intention, accounting for 22.4% of the variance ($\beta=0.224, p=0.004$). These findings highlight the importance of addressing privacy-related apprehensions, as students are more inclined to use ChatGPT when they feel assured about the security of their personal information.

Conversely, peer behavior and security concerns were found to negatively influence students' intentions to adopt ChatGPT, but their impacts were statistically insignificant. Peer behavior accounted for -3.2% of the variance ($\beta=-0.032, p>0.05$), and security concerns explained -5.9% of the variance ($\beta=-0.059, p>0.05$). The insignificance of peer behavior may be attributed to the novelty of ChatGPT as an emerging technology in the Indian higher education context. As generative AI tools like ChatGPT are still in their early stages of adoption, they have not yet reached the critical mass of users required for peer influence to become a significant factor (Rogers, 2003; Vanitha & Alathur, 2021). Furthermore, the individualistic nature of ChatGPT usage, which does not inherently require collaboration or peer endorsement, could

diminish the role of peer behavior in influencing adoption. Regarding security concerns, the insignificance could be explained by findings in developing nations where users tend to prioritize convenience and utility over security when adopting emerging technologies (Daniel, 2021; Neyazi et al., 2023). Students may lack awareness of security risks or may view these risks as secondary compared with the perceived benefits of using ChatGPT, such as ease of access and improved learning outcomes. Additionally, younger users in developing countries often demonstrate higher risk tolerance, which may reduce the perceived impact of security concerns on adoption (Al-Rahmi et al., 2018).

Additionally, perceived ease of participation contributed an additional 17.4% to the variance in intention ($\beta=0.174, p=0.013$), reaffirming its importance even when other variables are considered. Perceived usefulness and academic integrity were also identified as strong positive predictors. Perceived usefulness explained 23.4% of the variance ($\beta=0.234, p<0.001$), while academic integrity accounted for 29.1% ($\beta=0.291, p=0.003$). These results indicate that students are more inclined to use ChatGPT when they perceive it as beneficial and aligned with ethical academic standards.

The findings highlight the multifaceted factors influencing students' intentions to use ChatGPT. Positive determinants—such as perceived ease of participation, privacy concerns, perceived usefulness, and academic integrity—drive adoption, while negative influences—such as peer behavior and security concerns—pose challenges but have limited statistical significance in this context. Addressing the lack of peer influence may involve creating collaborative learning environments where ChatGPT's use is normalized and discussed among students. Similarly, raising awareness about security concerns through institutional training programs can help mitigate long-term risks while fostering trust. Understanding these dynamics can inform strategies to address barriers and promote factors that encourage ChatGPT adoption, ensuring its effective integration into educational and professional contexts (see Table 3; Figure 3).

Discussion and Implications

The findings of this study hold significant implications for the teaching and practice of business and professional communication. In this context, institutions must incorporate targeted training on ChatGPT's functionalities into business communication curricula (Kairu, 2022), offering hands-on assignments that enable students to explore its capabilities while critically evaluating its outputs (Abbas et al., 2022; Al-Emran et al., 2024). This approach will enhance not only technical proficiency but also critical thinking and ethical awareness, addressing varying levels of trust in AI-generated content (Muthmainnah et al., 2022). For instance, teachers can design assignments that require students to assess the reliability of ChatGPT's outputs, thereby enhancing their ability to discern useful and credible information (Baidoo-Anu & Ansah, 2023). Moreover, integrating AI literacy into workplace training programs is equally essential. Employers can leverage these tools to improve workplace productivity, but training must address ethical considerations, data privacy concerns, and the limitations of

Table 3. Goodness of Fit and Causal Relationships in ChatGPT Adoption Constructs.

Measure for Goodness of Fit		Causal Relationship			Standardized Estimate (β)	p-value	Hypothesis Decision
Elements	First Block	Second Block	Dependent Variable	Path Direction	Independent Variable		
CMIN/DF	7.515	2.95	Perceived usefulness	←	Perceived ease of participation	***	Supported
χ ²	1315.1	289.1					
DF	175	98	Intention to use ChatGPT	←	Privacy concerns	.004	Supported
GFI	.821	.945	Intention to use ChatGPT	←	Peer behavior	.769	Not supported
NFI	.824	.957	Intention to use ChatGPT	←	Academic integrity	.003	Supported
CFI	.853	.974	Intention to use ChatGPT	←	Perceive usefulness	***	Supported
RMSEA	.089	.043					
p value	.000	.000					
Decision on model							
The structural model is a good fit			Intention to use ChatGPT	←	Security concerns	.434	Not supported
with 5 modification indices and 4 item deletions.			Intention to use ChatGPT	←	Perceived ease of participation	.013	Supported

Source: Primary Data

Note. ***p < 0.001, indicating a statistically significant causal relationship between the independent and dependent variables.

CFI = comparative fit index; CMIN/DF = minimum discrepancy/degrees of freedom; GFI = goodness of fit index; NFI = normed fit index; RMSEA = root mean square error of approximation.

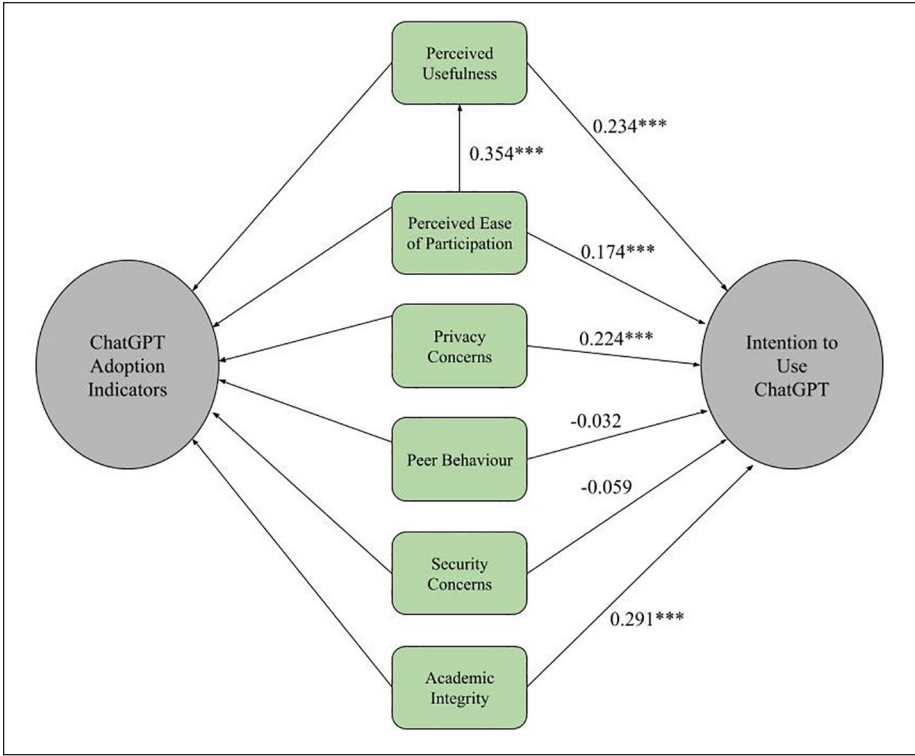


Figure 3. Results of ChatGPT Adoption and Usage Model.
Source: Primary Data.

AI-generated content to ensure responsible use (Foroughi et al., 2024). Preparing students for these challenges during their academic journey equips them with the skills needed to deal with the complexities of AI integration in professional environments (Bankins & Formosa, 2023).

The results confirmed that perceived usefulness and academic integrity are the strongest predictors of intention to use ChatGPT. This aligns with prior studies on technology acceptance (Eke, 2023; Kintu et al., 2017; Raza et al., 2022), highlighting the critical role of user perceptions in shaping adoption intention. Further, perceived usefulness, as the other significant predictor, demonstrates that students are more inclined to adopt ChatGPT when they perceive it as a valuable tool for enhancing learning outcomes. In this regard, previous research has shown similar findings, where perceived usefulness had a strong positive correlation with the intention to adopt educational technologies (Cooper, 2023; J. Li & Mak, 2022). For instance, studies on AI-enabled writing tools indicate that when students recognize practical benefits such as improved efficiency and enhanced learning, they are more willing to integrate these tools into academic workflows (Al-Bukhrani et al., 2025). In this context, teachers

play a crucial role in familiarizing students with ChatGPT's features and demonstrating its real-world applications in business communication, thereby promoting its meaningful integration into academic practices.

Our study found that perceived ease of participation also significantly influences intention, highlighting the importance of user-friendly interfaces in driving technology adoption. This finding resonates with research by Strzelecki (2023) and Crawford et al. (2023), emphasizing that students who find ChatGPT intuitive and easy to use are more likely to incorporate it into their learning processes. Thus, institutions must address this by providing adequate training and technical support to enhance students' confidence in using ChatGPT. By doing so, teachers can minimize the barriers to adoption, encouraging both initial engagement and long-term use.

Privacy concerns were found to have a notable positive impact on the intention to use ChatGPT, highlighting their relevance in shaping adoption behaviors (Jo & Bang, 2023). These findings align with studies on privacy-related factors in technology adoption (Gecas, 1982; Sitar-Taut & Mican, 2021; Tseng et al., 2022; Roe & Perkins, 2022). However, they contrast with research on platforms such as Google Classroom, where privacy concerns were less significant (Alotumi, 2022; Kulyk et al., 2020). This increased emphasis on privacy concerns likely stems from ChatGPT's reliance on large language models trained on extensive data sets, raising issues related to data security and ethical use (Cotton et al., 2024). Addressing these issues through transparent policies and robust data protection measures is essential to build trust and encourage adoption. Moreover, proactive communication about how ChatGPT safeguards user data can alleviate apprehensions and improve perceptions of the tool.

Conversely, peer behavior did not significantly influence intention, which aligns with findings from other studies on technology adoption (Eke, 2023; Wanner et al., 2022; de Winter et al., 2024). This could be attributed to ChatGPT's novelty, which limits its integration into peer-driven academic practices. As generative AI tools become more prevalent, peer behavior may gain relevance in shaping adoption dynamics. In this regard, institutions can play a pivotal role by advancing collaborative environments where students share experiences with ChatGPT, promoting shared learning and normalizing its use.

Security concerns, while not a significant predictor of intention, were found relevant for use behavior. This finding aligns with studies from developing nations where security concerns often have minimal direct effects on technology adoption (Ameri et al., 2020; Arain et al., 2019; Cardon et al., 2021). Although students may not explicitly consider security concerns during initial adoption, these issues could influence long-term engagement with ChatGPT (Lund & Wang, 2023). To better sensitize students, universities, and developers should prioritize addressing these concerns through robust safeguards and user education to ensure continued adoption.

Lastly, academic integrity emerged as a significant predictor of intention, reflecting students' awareness of the ethical considerations associated with generative AI tools. This finding emphasizes the importance of advancing discussions on responsible AI use in academic settings. Educators should establish clear ethical guidelines and incorporate them into curricula to guide students in using ChatGPT responsibly.

(Gude, 2023; Stahl & Eke, 2024). Such measures not only ensure compliance with academic standards but also prepare students for ethical challenges in professional contexts.

The findings of this study present several pivotal implications for pedagogical strategies and industry practices in the teaching and application of business communication, particularly in the context of integrating generative AI tools like ChatGPT.

To begin with, institutions must incorporate targeted training on ChatGPT's functionalities within business communication curricula. Such training should include hands-on assignments that encourage students to explore the tool's capabilities while critically evaluating its outputs (Abbas et al., 2022; Al-Emran et al., 2024). For instance, teachers could design tasks requiring students to assess the reliability and accuracy of ChatGPT's content, thereby advancing their ability to evaluate credible and practical information (Saenen et al., 2024). By implementing these initiatives, students not only improve their technical proficiency but also develop critical thinking and ethical awareness. This approach effectively addresses varying levels of trust in AI-generated outputs (Baidoo-Anu & Owusu Ansah, 2023; Muthmainnah et al., 2022).

Moreover, examples of classroom activities tailored to existing business communication courses can further enrich this discussion. For instance, one such activity could involve drafting a section of a corporate annual report using ChatGPT. Students would then engage in a critical analysis session to evaluate the accuracy of AI-generated content, assess how well the tone and style align with corporate standards, and explore ethical concerns, such as transparency in the use of AI for report writing (Kostka & Toncelli, 2023). This task would help develop essential skills such as critical thinking, ethical awareness, and proficiency in corporate communication standards. Another potential activity is using ChatGPT to generate drafts for persuasive emails or proposals. Students would then refine these drafts according to industry-specific guidelines. Such an exercise prepares them for real-world tasks while enhancing editing skills and encouraging ethical decision-making. By integrating these activities, students can achieve specific learning outcomes, such as demonstrating the ability to assess AI-generated content for accuracy and appropriateness and applying ethical guidelines in the integration of AI tools in professional writing (Kocon et al., 2023).

In addition to academic strategies, the findings emphasize the importance of incorporating AI literacy into workplace training programs (Mhlanga, 2023). Employers can leverage ChatGPT to enhance productivity; however, this requires equipping employees with the skills to address ethical considerations, data privacy issues, and limitations of AI-generated content (Foroughi et al., 2024). Incorporating these competencies into academic curricula is therefore critical. For educators, professional development workshops or collaborative research projects could serve as valuable tools to identify effective use cases for AI tools like ChatGPT. Furthermore, these initiatives can help educators understand the ethical and practical implications of AI in business communication and design curricula that balance AI usage with traditional communication skills.

Equally important is the establishment of clear guidelines for the ethical use of AI tools in both academic and professional contexts (Farhi et al., 2023). In this regard, teachers must guide students to responsibly integrate ChatGPT into their communication practices, emphasizing its practical applications while addressing concerns about reliability, accuracy, and academic integrity (Gundu, 2023). For instance, ethical guidelines must evolve to address emerging challenges, such as authorship credit when using generative AI and ensuring data privacy when interacting with AI tools (Gupta et al., 2023; Perkins, 2023; Ramdani, 2018). Through implementing such measures, students can adopt generative AI tools effectively while adhering to professional and ethical standards (de Sio, 2024; Ng et al., 2022).

Furthermore, these findings highlight the broader relevance of AI literacy in preparing students for real-world applications of generative AI. Promoting a culture of critical engagement with AI tools enables students to navigate the ethical and practical dimensions of using technologies like ChatGPT in both academic and workplace settings (Al-Emran et al., 2024). Therefore, by implementing these tools into higher education curricula, educators can ensure students develop a dual focus on academic and professional readiness (Guerrero-Dib et al., 2020). This approach facilitates their ability to harness generative AI meaningfully in business communication. It is also essential to acknowledge that students' perceptions of ChatGPT are likely to shift over time as they encounter the tool in professional settings or as societal debates and technological advancements unfold. Therefore, longitudinal studies could provide additional insights into how these perceptions evolve, thereby informing curriculum design.

Finally, the novelty of this study lies in its examination of ChatGPT adoption within the context of business communication courses among ESP learners in India. By uniquely evaluating predictors such as perceived usefulness, ease of participation, privacy concerns, academic integrity, and intention to use ChatGPT, this study addresses previously overlooked dimensions like security and academic integrity concerns. By exploring these factors, the research contributes to ongoing discussions on generative AI adoption. Moreover, it provides practical insights to guide the ethical and effective integration of ChatGPT into higher education. These findings offer a roadmap for equipping students with essential AI literacy skills, enabling them to adapt to the dynamic demands of academic and professional contexts.

Conclusion, Limitations, and Future Research Direction

The primary objective of this study was to investigate the adoption of ChatGPT among business communication students and to validate the significant influence of "Perceived usefulness," "Perceived ease of participation," "Privacy concerns," "Peer behavior," "Security concerns," and "Academic integrity" on the "Intention" to use ChatGPT. While this research provides valuable insights, its findings are limited by the specific context of two private universities in India. This scope restricts the generalizability of results to other institutions, particularly public universities or those outside the business communication domain. Nevertheless, the selected universities are highly reputed

and draw a diverse student class, lending credibility to the findings within this specific context.

The study's findings hold significant implications for policy and curriculum design. Institutions can utilize these results to integrate generative AI tools like ChatGPT into academic programs, ensuring alignment with ethical guidelines and enhancing AI literacy. By addressing concerns such as privacy and security, policymakers can develop a supportive environment for AI adoption while mitigating potential risks. Moreover, incorporating ChatGPT training into business communication curricula can help students develop critical thinking and practical skills for effective and responsible AI use.

Given that ChatGPT adoption in higher education remains a dynamic and evolving area, future research should focus on replicating and refining the methods employed in this study across diverse cultural and institutional settings. Expanding the scope to include public universities, international contexts, and non-business communication disciplines will provide a more comprehensive understanding of the factors influencing ChatGPT adoption. Additionally, longitudinal studies could examine the long-term impacts of ChatGPT integration on academic outcomes, skill development, and ethical practices. These efforts will contribute to the ethical and effective implementation of ChatGPT in education, ensuring its potential is fully realized across varied academic and cultural contexts.

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